

6. PAY FOR A SMALLER AMOUNT OF PILLS

If push comes to shove, and you really can't afford a thirty or ninety-day supply of meds, ask your pharmacist if they will separate the pills into smaller amounts to make payments more manageable.

\$100 a month for medications can be steep if you're on a tight budget or have fallen into the donut hole, but \$25 a week is a lot more manageable, especially if you're living paycheck to paycheck or are on a limited income.

You could also ask the doctor if they would be willing to prescribe a larger dose that you can then cut in half. The dispensing fee (a.k.a. your copay) will be the same, but you'll get more meds for your dollar.

JUST TO CLARIFY:

Donut Hole: *For those enrolled in Medicare Part D, you may have heard the term "Donut Hole." This refers to the gap when Medicare patients were required to pay 100% of their prescription drug costs after reaching a certain spending level, and would last until they had spent \$4,500 (2014) out-of-pocket. The Affordable Care Act is slowly shrinking this gap and allowing for more discounts and provisions for those inside the donut hole until it can get rid of it entirely.*

7. ENROLL IN A REWARDS PROGRAM

If for some reason your insurance doesn't offer a mail-order option, or you don't have a regular prescription to fill, consider a pharmacy that offers loyalty rewards.

- Walgreens adds 100 points to your Balance Rewards card every time you fill a prescription. 5,000 points = \$5.
- CVS gives \$5 in Extra Buck Rewards for every ten prescriptions.